EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 8 OCTOBER 2026

Rockport, Maine

The last strong El Niño gave Rockport three disaster-scale storms in four weeks, including the highest tide ever recorded at Portland. The harbour took the damage, but people die in a Maine winter on day three of an outage: from generators in basements, and in cold homes nobody checked. The most important step is to check every older household's CO alarm and put it on a paper list someone will walk when the power goes.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
Knox County, ME (inferred)	None published for the US, Maine, or the county	n/a here; global 6-month figure 239,000 ± 11,000	Clustered winter storms: multi-day outages and CO, coastal surge at the harbour

14/14 recommendations checked. 10 corrected, 2 confirmed as written (a pre-storm FEMA documentation pack, and holding the Maine Infrastructure Adaptation Fund for 2027), 1 unverified (parametric harbour cover), and 1 contraindicated (planning this winter's harbour works on hazard mitigation money that is already obligated). The four funding placements were checked separately: 1 confirmed, 2 corrected, 1 unverified. The emergency-fuel line was cut because ECIP is federal money that cannot take a private top-up. **The funding target fell 18%**, from $220k to $180k, inside the one-third flag. **Read the verdicts with care:** the shared web-search budget was exhausted before this run began, so lenses and verifiers fetched primary pages directly; Central Maine Power, MEMA, and some MaineHousing pages could not be read. Exposure: Climate Impact Lab, 451,000

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



44.19°N 69.08°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** People die here on day three of an outage, from generators in basements and in cold homes nobody checked: Maine's January 1998 ice storm left about 700,000 without power, for weeks in places.
- **First action.** Rockport Fire and pantry and church volunteers test and replace CO alarms door to door in older homes by 1 December, and tell people the generator goes outside.*
- **The money.** $45k floor, $180k target, about $332.5k ceiling; the floor pays for CO alarms and outreach, and the waterfront is excluded because FEMA money already covers it.
- **Do not.** Do not make "buy a generator" the headline outage advice: generators caused 30 of the 42 CO incidents in Maine's 1998 storm.*

What to do	**7** actions	p. 2
Who does what	RACI chart	p. 8
Where money does the most	funding	p. 8
Do not do this	**3** items	p. 10
What has happened here	the record	p. 11
How this was produced	methodology	p. 13
References	sources	p. 14

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

at Risk, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It publishes no figure for the United States, Maine, or Knox County, and heat is not this place's winter hazard.

Read this first: El Niño is a weak guide here, and the plan should outlive it. NOAA gives a strong-to-very-strong El Niño through January–March 2027, but its winter signal in midcoast Maine is weak. Maine's largest outage on record, the October 2017 storm, happened outside one. What the record does show is clustering. In the strong 1997–98 El Niño, the January 1998 ice storm left about 700,000 of Maine's 1.2 million residents without power. In the strong 2023–24 El Niño, the 17–21 December storm cut about 300,000 Maine customers, and the 10 and 13 January surge storms set Portland's all-time high-water record (14.57 ft above mean lower low water, 13 January 2024). In 1998 the deaths that could be prevented came from carbon monoxide, not ice. So the plan is built for clustered outages and CO, and the Skeptic's warning stands: if the town builds this around “the El Niño”, it will stand down in March, and the next nor'easter will not care.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED

Actions are ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. The backing lenses are shown on each action, and the RACI chart below assigns each one. An action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet, but only where its evidence came from somewhere like here. One rule underlies every outage action: staff for day three, when the generators are running in garages and the volunteers are tired.

1. Test and replace CO alarms door to door in long-held older homes, and tell people the generator goes outside, never in the basement or garage

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · EMERGENCY MGR · PUBLIC HEALTH · FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST · INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Rockport Fire (Home Safety Campaign), with pantry and church volunteers	1 Dec, before the first outage	$45k for alarms and outreach, county-wide (see funding)	CO poisoning during multi-day outages, the 1998 killer

In the January 1998 ice storm, Maine recorded 100 CO poisonings and 1 death from 42 incidents: 30 from gasoline generators, 8 from kerosene heaters, and 4 from propane heaters. 31.4% of households used a generator. The strongest risk factor was a generator in a basement or attached structure (Daley et al., *J Emerg Med* 2000). In a separate CDC survey of 36 households without power in Norway,

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Oxford County, only 3 had a working CO alarm. Maine law (25 MRSA §2468) already requires CO alarms in rentals, new homes, and single-family homes acquired after 31 October 2009. **So the gap is long-held, owner-occupied older homes**, which is the profile of older year-round residents in Rockville and Simonton Corners. The action: test, replace, and fill gaps in those homes, and carry one message: run the generator outdoors, never in a basement, garage, or attached porch.*

Transferability: Maine data, same hazard. Hampson (2017) finds alarm laws "probably cost-effective" but notes real-world effectiveness is unmeasured. The often-quoted "8 deaths" for the 1998 storm traces to a prepper blog and is not used. Rockport alone is too small to absorb 1,000 alarms, so aim them across Knox County. The $35 unit price is unverified.

2. Build a paper check-in roster of isolated and power-dependent residents, walked within 12 hours of losing power

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · PUBLIC HEALTH · FRONTLINE · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Camden Area Christian Food Pantry and churches, with Rockport Fire; enrollees register with CMP themselves	**Roster built by 1 Dec**	**Volunteer time; *unfunded*, small**	**Older and oxygen-dependent residents left alone in a cold house for days**

Neither Rockport nor Knox County keeps a vulnerable-residents register. The county EMA page points medical-device users to a brochure and 211. The Frontline lens's point is the core of this action: the people who most need help are the older resident whose phone line is down and the family that could not afford the October fill, and neither will call 211. They will answer the door to a neighbour they know from the pantry line. The Camden Area Christian Food Pantry (128 Mt Battie St) serves Rockport, Hope, and Union. Build a consent-based roster on paper, because phones and internet fail. Size it against HHS emPOWER's count for ZIP 04856, and set a rule: every name visited within 12 hours of power loss. Enrollees should register with Central Maine Power themselves, but never rely on that for faster restoration.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: the mortality evidence is from a summer city blackout. In New York in 2003, accidental deaths rose 122% (95% CI 28–287%) and non-accidental deaths 25% (Anderson & Bell, *Epidemiology* 2012). That is weak evidence for winter in rural Maine. emPOWER covers Medicare only and shows any count from 1 to 11 as 11, so it undercounts. CMP's medical-priority registry could not be reached. Do not tell anyone it guarantees priority restoration.

3. Have the town designate a warming and charging site now: generator confirmed, 10–15 named volunteers, transport, and a 72-hour test

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · FRONTLINE · HISTORIAN · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Town of Rockport (emergency management director) and Rockport Fire; Knox County EMA supporting	Site and roster by 15 Nov; 72-hour test by 15 Dec	Fuel and volunteer time; $25k county pool held (see funding)	No site opening because no one volunteered in advance

Knox County EMA says warming sites “are only going to open if the municipality feels there is a need and if they have volunteers to staff it.” So this is the town's job, not the county's. No designated warming centre or generator was found for the Rockport Public Library (1 Limerock St) or either fire station. Ask the town office before assuming none exists. The action: designate a site, confirm or install a generator, name a three-shift volunteer roster, and link it to the roster in action 2 for transport. Then run a 72-hour test with the generator under load and a fuel delivery. Plan for three events, not one: in 2023–24 the second and third storms arrived before repairs from the first were finished.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: native. The Skeptic warns that Maine warming centres have drawn low attendance and do nothing for people who cannot drive. The 2009 report behind that could not be reached, but the transport logic holds, which is why the roster link matters. Correction: Rockport Fire now has 8 full-time staff on 24-hour shifts, and Rescue 25 in West Rockport is staffed around the clock. The 7am–6pm duty crew a lens cited is out of date.

4. Key the harbour to the tide table: when a surge or onshore gale lands on a spring or perigean high, secure floats, clear the wharf, and keep people off

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN · SKEPTIC | INVENTORY: CHANGE IN FORECAST QUALITY (SHRADER ET AL. 2023), INDIRECT

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Harbormaster and Public Works	Tide calendar flagged by 1 Nov	Staff time	Repeat float and equipment losses; people on the wharf at peak surge

Portland's NOAA gauge recorded 14.556 ft above mean lower low water at 12:06 on 13 January 2024, the highest on record. The January 2024 storms were declared DR-4764, with Knox County designated for Public Assistance and $50.1M obligated statewide. Rockport's own harbour plan says the harbour “has flooded during major storm events several times” and that repeated repairs are “unsustainable.” Construction “will not begin until the funding has been secured”, so this winter meets the same unbuilt waterfront. The action: flag every winter spring and perigean high from NOAA predictions. When a forecast surge or onshore gale coincides with one, check moorings 24 hours ahead, secure or pull floats, move town equipment off the wharf, close Marine Park, and keep the public off the harbour at peak tide.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: native. Corrections: Rockport Harbor opens south, so key the trigger to surge plus wind direction, not “southeasterly” alone. The page gives no selection date for the design consultant (17 February 2026 is a task-force memo). The “6 inches in Rockport Marine's shop” quote could not be re-checked. No harbour injuries or deaths were found for January 2024; Maine's storm deaths that winter were in the December inland floods, in counties Knox was not part of. This action protects property and responders more than residents' lives.

5. Get households to heat: book HEAP now, call Penquis for ECIP from 1 November, and set up PUC payment arrangements

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Penquis (Knox County's community action agency); pantry and Homeworthy for sign-up help; utilities and Maine PUC	**HEAP appointments now; ECIP from 1 Nov**	**Benefits already funded; outreach time**	**Older people in cold homes when the October fill is unaffordable**

Heating oil is at a record of about $6.02 a gallon, 81% above a year ago. HEAP opened on 3 August 2026, with a cap of $73,213 for a household of four. ECIP, for an “extremely low supply of heating fuel,” runs from 1 November 2026 to 30 April 2027 and requires a HEAP application first. Penquis has more than 6,500 priority appointments booked, and scheduling “extends to the end of the year”, so pre-qualification by 1 November is not assured. Book now, and phone Penquis directly once ECIP opens for anyone already low on fuel. In FY25 Penquis gave HEAP to 1,026 Knox households. On electricity, anyone at or below 150% of the poverty line or eligible for HEAP can get a PUC Special Payment Arrangement, and no late fees apply while it holds.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Transferability: native. Correction: Maine's winter rule (35-A M.R.S. §718) is not a ban. An electric utility needs prior PUC permission for each winter disconnection, and the statute covers electricity only, not oil or propane. The ECIP benefit amount is not published.

6. Fishermen: life jackets, man-overboard alarms, and reboarding ladders on boats fished alone

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Maine Lobstermen's Association, with the Harbormaster	Standing; push before winter hauling	*Unfunded*; no free Maine life-jacket programme found	Falls-overboard deaths

From 2000 to 2016, 204 US fishermen died from falls overboard, and none was wearing a life jacket. East Coast lobster accounted for 18. A man-overboard alarm was used in only one event, and CDC recommends ladders for anyone fishing alone (MMWR 2018).

Transferability: national data. No El Niño link, and the volume of winter lobstering in Penobscot Bay was not verified. Treat it as standing safety work, not El Niño preparation. Fishing Partnership's training offices are in Massachusetts and Rhode Island.

7. Back the usual autumn vaccination drive for people 65 and over, and expect a modest effect

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Pen Bay Medical Center / MaineHealth and pharmacies	Before December	Existing programmes	Winter respiratory deaths in an old county

Winter respiratory deaths are the largest pool of winter deaths here. Knox County's median age is reported as 49.5, against 38.9 for the US (ACS 2024; not re-verified). Vaccinate for flu, COVID, and RSV, but do not quote the 48–50% lower all-cause death figure (Nichol, *NEJM* 2003). Jackson (*Int J Epidemiol* 2006) found vaccinated seniors had a relative risk of 0.39 *before* flu season began, when the vaccine could not have been working. That is healthy-user bias, and it means the real benefit is smaller than the headline.

Transferability: good evidence for vaccination, but this is not an El Niño action. The only link is people crowding indoors during outages.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	Town of Rockport	Rockport Fire	Harbormaster & Public Works	Knox County EMA	MEMA	Camden Area Christian Food Pantry & churches	Homeworthy	Rockport Public Library	Penquis	Central Maine Power & Maine PUC	Maine Lobstermen's Assn	Pen Bay Medical / MaineHealth	NWS Gray
1. CO alarm test and replace; generator message	C	A/R		C		R	I		I			C	
2. Paper check-in roster, 12-hour rule	C	R		C		A/R	C	I		I		C	
3. Warming site, volunteers, 72-hour test	A	R	C	C	I	R	C	C		I			I
4. Tide-keyed harbour trigger	C	C	A/R	I							I		C
5. HEAP, ECIP, PUC arrangements	I					R	R	I	A/R	R			
6. Life jackets, alarms, ladders			C								A/R		I
7. Autumn vaccination 65+		I				C	C					A/R	

What the chart shows. **Rockport Fire is on every outage row**, and it is a small department with 8 full-time staff and a volunteer roster, so its capacity in a three-storm winter is the plan's biggest dependency. **The town, not the county, is accountable for the warming site**, because the county opens nothing without a town's volunteers. **The pantry and churches carry the roster**; it has no public owner, and that is deliberate, because people answer the door to someone they know. **MEMA sits almost empty**: its role this winter is after the event, not before it.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs. The waterfront is excluded on purpose: about $50M of FEMA money already covers it.

FLOOR	TARGET	CEILING	LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
$45k	$180k	~$332.5k	How many Knox households run out of fuel, and how much private emergency-fuel money Penquis can actually move

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Floor: $45k for CO alarms and outreach. **Target:** $45k + $60k for emergency fuel (100 deliveries × $600) + $50k for Homeworthy cash + $25k for the warming pool, which totals $180k. **Ceiling:** $52.5k + $15k (1,500 alarms and outreach) + $150k (250 deliveries × $600) + $75k + $40k, which totals $332.5k. The target fell 18% from the lens's $220k, because ECIP cannot take private money and the private channel that can, Penquis's Good Neighbor fund, is small. At about $6 a gallon, the lens's $400 delivery would buy only about 66 gallons.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
Rockport Fire with Knox County EMA	Action 1: ~1,000 CO alarms, test and replace, across Knox County	$45k	Pre-positioned stock	~$35 a unit (unverified) plus $10k outreach; 1998 Maine CO outbreak (Daley 2000). Aim at homes the 2009 law misses	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Penquis Good Neighbor Heating Assistance (not ECIP)	Action 5: emergency fuel for Knox households once HEAP and ECIP run out	$60k (was $100k)	Top-up to the private fund	100 × $600 at ~$6/gal; Good Neighbor served 103 Knox people for ~$25k in FY25, so this is four times its usual year. Chirakijja et al. (cheaper heat cuts winter deaths) used only for direction	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
Homeworthy (formerly Knox County Homeless Coalition)	Actions 2–3: ~250 cash transfers of $200 for fuel, repairs, or a motel during outages	$50k	Unconditional cash via its urgent-needs channel	Spent $4.79M with 88 staff in FY2024, so $50k is about 1% of its budget. No history of unconditional cash grants found	CONFIRMED
Knox County EMA and towns	Action 3: staffing and generator fuel for warming and charging sites	$25k, held	Pooled fund, conditional	No sites, generators, or budget found on EMA or town pages. Release once the EMA names sites and confirms costs are not already covered	UNVERIFIED

The funder's one thing: the storm surge makes the headlines, and it is already the best-funded hazard in Knox County. The deaths in a Maine winter come quietly, from cold homes and generators running in basements, and nobody pays for that last mile. Fuel money that arrives in January buys oil after the cold snap has already done its harm.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

DO NOT DO THIS CONTRAINDICATED

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives or waste the window here.

Plan this winter's harbour protection around open hazard mitigation money

CONTRAINDICATED AS WRITTEN

The Historian proposed using DR-4754's $4.17M and DR-4764's $2.05M in hazard mitigation grants for interim measures this winter. Those sums are *obligated*, meaning already committed to approved projects, not spare balances. Hazard mitigation application and project cycles run in years.

Instead: ask MEMA whether any balance is genuinely open, but pay for this winter's float pulls and wharf clearing from the town budget (action 4). If the town receives FEMA repair money after a storm, ask for Section 406 mitigation, such as elevation, as part of the repair. It is discretionary, not automatic, so it has to be requested and justified.

Make “buy a generator” the headline outage advice *

AVOID (SKEPTIC; SUPPORTED BY DALEY 2000)

Generators caused 30 of the 42 CO incidents in Maine's 1998 storm, and the strongest risk factor was running one in a basement or attached structure. Advice that sells the generator without the placement rule and the alarm is advice that produced the 1998 poisonings.

Instead: pair every generator message with a working CO alarm and “outdoors, never in the basement, garage, or porch” (action 1).

Top up ECIP with private money

NOT POSSIBLE AS PROPOSED

ECIP is a federal, LIHEAP-funded crisis benefit run by Penquis; donor money cannot be added to it. The lens's $100k placement assumed it could.

Instead: route private fuel money to Penquis's Good Neighbor Heating Assistance fund, sized to what it can move (funding table, row 2).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
2 Feb 1976	Groundhog Day Gale: 60-kt gusts at Rockland; the Penobscot rose 12 ft in about 15 minutes at Bangor	Not found	n/a
Feb 1978	Blizzard set the previous Portland high-water record (not re-verified)	Not found	n/a
Jan 1998	Ice storm during a strong El Niño; ~700,000 of 1.2 million Mainers without power, for weeks in places	100 CO poisonings, 1 CO death (Daley); “8 deaths” weakly sourced	National Guard mobilised; line crews from as far as North Carolina
Oct 2017	Wind storm: Maine's largest outage on record, >400,000; outages over a week (ENSO phase not verified)	Not found	n/a
17–21 Dec 2023	Strong El Niño: rain and wind, ~300,000 Maine outages; DR-4754 (Knox not designated)	At least 2 flood deaths in Maine	$38.1M public assistance; $4.17M hazard mitigation obligated
10 & 13 Jan 2024	Surge storms; Portland record 14.57 ft MLLW on 13 Jan; DR-4764 (Knox designated)	No harbour casualties found; Knox: 24 NFIP claims, 19 paid, $1.28M	$50.1M public assistance statewide; Rockport harbour plan
2025–26	Rockport harbour study and Phase 1 design; $2M resiliency grant	n/a	Construction awaits funding
Oct 2026	Heating oil at a record ~$6.02/gal, +81% on a year	n/a	Governor calls federal LIHEAP “insufficient”

The recurrence nobody has noticed: Rockport's exposure is clustered winter storms, not one big storm, and the two worst clusters on record (1998 and 2023–24) both came in strong El Niño winters. The harbour has been met with another repair after each flood, which the town's own plan calls unsustainable. This El Niño will probably hit the same unbuilt waterfront, so the decisions that matter now are what gets done this winter with the money already in hand.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **The harbour is the threat** (Emergency manager, Historian, Economist) versus **cold homes and CO are the threat** (Public health, Philanthropist, Frontline). The record has property losses at the harbour and deaths in outages, so this report ranks the outage actions first. The harbour action protects property and responders, and it is cheap.
- **Build around this El Niño** versus **El Niño's winter signal is weak here** (Skeptic, Public health). The clustering in 1998 and 2023–24 supports preparing now. The Skeptic's point is about duration: keep every measure in place after March.
- **Warming centres** (Emergency manager, Frontline) versus **warming centres nobody can drive to** (Skeptic). Resolved by tying the site to the roster and to transport (actions 2 and 3).

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

No lens examined **heat pumps**, which many Maine homes now rely on and which stop in a power cut; the Skeptic raised it, but no data was found. No lens found **Maine CDC carbon monoxide counts** for the December 2023 and January 2024 outages, so the CO case rests on 1998. No lens looked at **road access**: in 2017 some coastal roads were impassable for over a week, which bears on whether rescue and fuel deliveries reach the peninsula roads at all.

HOW TO READ THIS — METHOD

The panel is author-built. Seven simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people, and are not neighbourhood figures. Knox County holds about 41,000, so its impact region is probably larger than the county; it was inferred, not resolved. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; outages, surge, and cold are carried here by the record rather than by a published number.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Scope.** The location was taken as given: the Town of Rockport, Maine, on Penobscot Bay, including Rockport Harbor, Marine Park, Rockport village, Glen Cove, Rockville, and Simonton Corners. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as this report records it: Knox County, ME, *inferred* rather than resolved on the Impact Map. Where lenses used administrative data, the unit is named: the State of Maine (1998 CO cases, outages), Knox County (FEMA designations, NFIP claims, HEAP caseload, median age), and ZIP 04856 (emPOWER). None is Rockport alone.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality.
- **Expert panel.** Seven simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, and philanthropist) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias before it counted. The six-lens convergence on CO alarms rests on a Maine-specific outbreak study, so it held. The lenses' convergence on the January 1998 “8 deaths” did not: it traced to a single weak source. Contradictions were kept. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort, each given a payer or marked unfunded, and the funding placements reconciled against them.
- **Verification.** Five separate verifier agents checked 14 recommendations and the four funding placements for evidence, transferability, and feasibility. Financial actions were also checked for availability, payer, trigger, and existing implementation, and the envelope for real recipients, unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not re-opened in this run. The inventory's US filter (19 entries) was read in a browser earlier the same day for the Gaslamp Quarter briefing, and those titles were used here. Only *Change in forecast quality* (Shrader et al. 2023) bears, indirectly, on the tide trigger. No US entry covers CO alarms, check-in rosters, warming centres, or fuel assistance.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (carbon monoxide, generators, CO alarms, and warming sites) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total without the division being shown and labelled. The average NFIP claim ($1,279,136 ÷ 19 paid = ~$67.3k) and Good Neighbor's per-person figure (~$25k ÷ 103) are shown divisions. No local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. **The shared web-search budget was exhausted before this run began**, so every lens and verifier fetched pages directly, and cmpco.com, MEMA, the Census API, and some MaineHousing and FEMA policy pages could not be reached. No Rockport or Knox County death figure for any winter storm was found. Knox County's median age and Rockport's 65+ share were not re-verified.

References · verified by Phase 5 unless marked. Daley et al. 2000, 1998 Maine CO outbreak (verified) · CDC MMWR 1998, CO alarm survey (corrected) · 25 MRSA §2468, CO detectors (verified) · Hampson 2017 (verified) · Anderson & Bell 2012 (verified) · HHS emPOWER map (verified) · Knox County EMA preparedness (verified) · Rockport Fire (corrected) · Camden Area Christian Food Pantry (lens, not re-verified) · Rockport harbour plan (corrected) · NOAA Portland gauge, Jan 2024 (verified) · FEMA DR-4764 (verified) · FEMA DR-4754 (verified) · OpenFEMA NFIP claims (corrected) · MaineHousing HEAP and ECIP (verified) · Penquis heating assistance (verified) · Penquis Knox FY25 summary (verified) · Maine PUC FAQ (verified) · 35-A M.R.S. §718 (verified) · Maine heating fuel prices (verified) · Homeworthy financials (verified) · Homeworthy (verified) · Maine Infrastructure Adaptation Fund (verified) · MMWR 2018, fishing falls overboard (verified) · Nichol 2003 (verified) · Jackson 2006 (verified) · CPC ENSO advisory (verified) · January 1998 ice storm (corrected) · 1976 Groundhog Day Gale (lens, not re-verified) · October 2017 storm (lens, not re-verified) · December 2023 storm (verified)
Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory (US)
Generated 8 October 2026 for Rockport, Maine. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

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